



Sri Lanka Labour Force Survey

Quarterly Report

2nd Quarter - 2025

SRI LANKA LABOUR FORCE SURVEY

**Quarterly Report – 2025
Second Quarter**

**Department of Census and Statistics
Ministry of Finance, Planning and Economic Development**

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Preface

Department of Census and Statistics has a long history of conducting the Labour Force Survey (LFS) in Sri Lanka. For instance, before 1990 this survey was conducted at every five yearly time intervals and from 1990 onward it was conducted as a regular survey to provide quarterly and annual labour force indicators. Labour Force Surveys provide various labour force indicators including employment and unemployment status of the country. Specially the survey provides necessary information to compile GDP and other important economic indicators of the country.

Various improvements were incorporated into the LFS during past period without breaking its core concepts and definitions which were used since 1990. In 2006, new modules were added to the LFS to capture the information on computer literacy, household economic activities and informal sector employment. The structure of the LFS questionnaire which was used during 2006-2012 was revised in 2013 with new improvements for concepts and classifications used. It is important to note that in 2013 the definition of working age population was revised from age ten and above population to age fifteen and above population.

In 2016, published labour force estimates from 2011 to 2015 were revised according to the population estimates of the Census of Population and Housing which was conducted in 2012. This revision was done along with the international best practices.

Another major achievement for data collection for LFS was taken place in 2017 with the introduction of Computer Assisted Data Collection (CAPI) using tablet computers. Before 2017 enumerators used paper based method and used survey questionnaires to record the answers given by the respondents. A known probability sampling technique is used to select the sample and the annual labour force indicators are compiled using 25,000 housing units covering the entire country. The enumerators who are permanent officers of the Department visited each of these randomly selected housing units to collect the information with a great effort. The field work of the survey for the second quarter 2025 was done in the month of April, May and June in year 2025. This report is based on the data collected in quarterly sample of 6,250 housing units.

I hope the information in this report is very valuable and useful to make evidence based decisions for various users to identify the issues as well as the changes in the labour market of Sri Lanka.

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27.10.2025.

Acknowledgements

This report is the hundred and thirty fifth in the series of the Quarterly Labour Force Survey which was commenced from the first quarter of 1990 and is being continued by the Department of Census and Statistics.

Planning and execution of the survey was done by the staff of the Sample Surveys Division under the guidance of Ms. K.M.D.S.D. Karunaratne, Additional Director General (Statistics) and Mr. S.H. Mansoor, Director (Statistics) and under the direction of Dr(Ms). M.D.D.D. Deepawansa, Deputy Director (Statistics), Sample Surveys Division.

The survey activities were organized and supervised by Ms. H.M.D. Sepalika, Mr. T.D.M.S.D. Perera, Ms. U.S. Dilrukshi, Mr. L.S.N. Perera, Ms. M.W.L.C.M. Chandrarathne, Ms. M.M.G.D Manamperi, Ms. R.P.M. Subhashini, Mr. H.M.S.C. Bandara, Ms. C.R. Liyanage and Ms. A.H.L.T. Sandaruwini, Statisticians, of the Sample Surveys Division.

The computer data processing and final tabulations were done by Mr. A.M.A.E. Atapattu Statistical Officer of the Sample Surveys Division, under the supervision of Ms. M.W.L.C.M. Chandrarathne, Statistician. The Statistical Officers, Statistical Assistants, Development Officers, Information and Communication Technology Assistants and Data Entry Operators/ Coding Clerks of the Sample Survey Division are acknowledged for their valuable contribution during the whole survey process.

The Information & Communication Technology Division, Mr. K.L.C.S. Weerasooriya, Additional Director General (ICT) and Mr. E.M.D. Ekanayake, Director (ICT) were responsible for implementing CAPI methodology and preparation of data collection and computer edits programmes.

This publication was organized and prepared by Ms. M.W.L.C.M. Chandrarathne, Statistician, Sample Surveys Division, assisted by Mr. A.M.A.E. Atapattu Statistical Officer, under the guidance of Dr(Ms). M.D.D.D. Deepawansa, Director (Statistics) and Ms. W.A.D.R.D. Athukorala, Deputy Director (Statistics), Sample Surveys Division.

District staff of the Department who worked on the survey deserves a special word of thanks. The Deputy Directors/ Senior Statisticians/ Statisticians supervised the survey and field Statistical Officers, worked hard at the data collection stage, to make this survey a success.

Finally, I wish to express my appreciation to all the respondents of the survey for their valuable cooperation.

Selected Labour Force Indicators

Indicator	Year / Quarter									
	2019	2020	2021	2022	2023	2024	2023Q2	2024Q2	2025Q1	2025Q2
Labour force participation rate										
By Gender										
Total	52.3	50.6	49.9	49.8	48.6	47.4	48.6	47.8	49.7	49.3
Male	73.0	71.9	71.0	70.5	68.6	67.4	68.8	68.1	70.1	69.5
Female	34.5	32.0	31.8	32.1	31.3	29.8	31.1	30.0	32.0	31.7
By residential sector										
Total	52.3	50.6	49.9	49.8	48.6	47.4	48.6	47.8	49.7	49.3
Urban	50.2	47.0	46.9	47.2	46.0	44.3	46.8	45.4	47.0	45.7
Rural	52.7	51.3	50.5	50.3	49.1	48.0	49.0	48.3	50.2	50.1
Unemployment Rate										
By Gender										
Total	4.8	5.5	5.1	4.7	4.7	4.4	5.2	4.7	3.8	3.8
Male	3.3	4.0	3.7	3.7	3.6	3.0	4.1	3.6	2.5	2.6
Female	7.4	8.5	7.9	6.5	7.0	7.1	7.4	7.0	6.3	6.0
By selected age Group (Year)										
20 - 29	15.3	18.1	18.3	16.2	17.0	16.1	16.4	16.9	13.8	13.8
20 - 24	20.3	25.2	26.8	21.8	21.6	20.7	22.0	23.7	18.3	19.6
25 - 29	11.0	12.0	11.4	11.7	13.0	12.5	11.6	11.2	10.1	9.3
By selected educational level										
GCE A/L and above										
Total	8.5	9.8	9.1	7.8	8.0	7.8	8.0	7.8	6.1	5.9
Male	5.0	6.2	6.2	5.5	5.8	5.4	6.3	5.8	4.2	3.0
Female	11.9	13.6	12.2	10.1	10.2	10.3	9.9	10.0	8.2	9.1
Employed population										
By Gender										
Total	8,180,693	7,999,093	8,113,507	8,147,731	8,009,916	7,949,751	8,014,492	7,988,626	8,139,605	8,172,638
Male	5,368,896	5,372,947	5,414,280	5,373,965	5,307,563	5,358,554	5,323,491	5,379,472	5,399,400	5,446,537
Female	2,811,796	2,626,146	2,699,228	2,773,766	2,702,354	2,591,197	2,691,001	2,609,154	2,740,205	2,726,101
By industry (Percentage)										
Total	8,180,693	7,999,093	8,113,507	8,147,731	8,009,916	7,949,751	8,014,492	7,988,626	8,139,605	8,172,638
%	100.0	100.0	100.0	100.0	100.0	100.0	100.0	100.0	100.0	100.0
Agriculture	2,071,940	2,169,679	2,213,015	2,158,559	2,088,344	2,066,651	2,058,421	2,000,744	1,906,832	2,104,353
%	25.3	27.1	27.3	26.5	26.1	26.0	25.7	25.0	23.4	25.7
Industry	2,258,421	2,152,746	2,109,482	2,158,199	2,043,154	2,031,417	2,104,249	2,116,002	2,135,102	2,063,914
%	27.6	26.9	26.0	26.5	25.5	25.6	26.3	26.5	26.2	25.3
Services	3,850,332	3,676,668	3,791,011	3,830,973	3,878,418	3,851,683	3,851,822	3,871,880	4,097,671	4,004,372
%	47.1	46.0	46.7	47.0	48.4	48.5	48.1	48.5	50.3	49.0
By no. of hours worked per week (percentage)										
Total	100.0	100.0	100.0	100.0	100.0	100.0	100.0	100.0	100.0	100.0
0*	6.4	14.6	9.6	5.8	4.2	2.5	4.8	4.0	1.6	3.7
1 - 9	1.7	2.1	2.0	2.1	2.4	1.8	2.6	2.2	1.6	2.3
10 - 39	26.8	27.1	29.6	31.9	31.2	28.3	32.6	29.4	28.1	30.6
40 & above	65.1	56.2	58.7	60.3	62.1	67.4	60.0	64.3	68.7	63.3

* has a job but not at work during the reference week

Note : Working age population considered as (age 15 & over population)

Sri Lanka Labour Force Survey 2025

First Quarter

Summary Statistics on Labour Force Characteristics

15 years & over population

	Total	Male	Female	Urban	Rural
Population (15 years & over)	17,214,317	8,049,609	9,164,708	3,016,225	14,198,091
Labour force in this age group	8,491,296	5,590,609	2,900,687	1,379,851	7,111,445
Labour force participation rate	49.3	69.5	31.7	45.7	50.1
Employed population	8,172,638	5,446,537	2,726,101	1,330,106	6,842,533
Employment rate	96.2	97.4	94.0	96.4	96.2
Unemployed population	318,657	144,071	174,586	49,745	268,912
Unemployment rate	3.8	2.6	6.0	3.6	3.8
Not in labour force	8,723,021	2,459,000	6,264,021	1,636,374	7,086,646

18 years & over population

	Total	Male	Female	Urban	Rural
Population (18 years & over)	16,069,954	7,474,685	8,595,270	2,849,417	13,220,537
Labour force in this age group	8,451,260	5,556,779	2,894,481	1,374,740	7,076,520
Labour force participation rate	52.6	74.3	33.7	48.2	53.5
Employed population	8,147,125	5,426,058	2,721,068	1,326,408	6,820,718
Employment rate	96.4	97.6	94.0	96.5	96.4
Unemployed population	304,135	130,722	173,413	48,333	255,802
Unemployment rate	3.6	2.4	6.0	3.5	3.6
Not in labour force	7,618,694	1,917,905	5,700,789	1,474,677	6,144,017

20 years & over population

	Total	Male	Female	Urban	Rural
Population (20 years & over)	15,382,456	7,131,748	8,250,708	2,730,403	12,652,053
Labour force in this age group	8,353,243	5,492,883	2,860,360	1,357,462	6,995,781
Labour force participation rate	54.3	77.0	34.7	49.7	55.3
Employed population	8,070,842	5,371,000	2,699,841	1,310,969	6,759,873
Employment rate	96.6	97.8	94.4	96.6	96.6
Unemployed population	282,401	121,883	160,519	46,493	235,908
Unemployment rate	3.4	2.2	5.6	3.4	3.4
Not in labour force	7,029,213	1,638,865	5,390,348	1,372,941	5,656,272

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Appendix 1: Explanatory Notes

Appendix 2: Alternative estimates of employment, unemployment and labour force characteristics

Labour Force

All persons aged 15 years & over who are currently economically active during the reference period (Labour Force = employed persons + unemployed persons)

Reference Period:

Previous week of the survey week
(3rd week of every month)

Labour force participation rate (LFPR)

Labour force as a percentage of the population aged 15 years and over.

Labour Force (Economically Active Population)

Table 1: Economically active population by gender and sector, second quarter - 2025

Sector	Economically Active Population					
	Total	%	Male	%	Female	%
Sri Lanka	8,491,296	100	5,590,609	65.8	2,900,687	34.2
Urban	1,379,851	100	900,214	65.2	479,637	34.8
Rural	6,751,339	100	4,466,501	66.2	2,284,838	33.8
Estate	360,106	100	223,894	62.2	136,212	37.8

Table 2: Economically inactive population by gender and sector, second quarter - 2025

Sector	Economically Inactive Population					
	Total	%	Male	%	Female	%
Sri Lanka	8,723,021	100	2,459,000	28.2	6,264,021	71.8
Urban	1,636,374	100	468,194	28.6	1,168,180	71.4
Rural	6,755,752	100	1,865,234	27.6	4,890,518	72.4
Estate	330,894	100	125,572	37.9	205,322	62.1

According to the Table 1, the estimated economically active population is about 8.5 million in the second quarter 2025. Of which 65.8 percent are males and 34.2 percent are females. The economically inactive population is about 8.7 million. Out of the economically inactive population 28.2 percent are males and 71.8 percent are females (Table 2).

Table 3: LFPR by gender and year, 2019 - 2025Q2

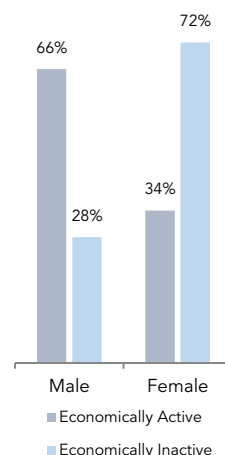
Year	Total	Male	Female
2019	52.3	73.0	34.5
2020	50.6	71.9	32.0
2021	49.9	71.0	31.8
2022	49.8	70.5	32.1
2023	48.6	68.6	31.3
2024	47.4	67.4	29.8
2023 Q2	48.6	68.8	31.1
2024 Q2	47.8	68.1	30.0
2025 Q1	49.7	70.1	32.0
2025 Q2	49.3	69.5	31.7

Table 3 provides the information on LFPRs by gender since year 2019. Referring the Table 3, it is important to note that, male participation to the labour force is always higher than that of female.

Table 4: LFPR by age group and gender, second quarter - 2025

Age group (Years)	Total	Male	Female
Sri Lanka	49.3	69.5	31.7
15 - 19	7.5	10.6	4.4
20 - 24	45.2	59.1	33.0
25 - 29	67.9	88.2	47.8
30 - 34	65.7	94.1	43.9
35 - 39	67.3	94.9	44.4
40 - 44	67.5	95.3	42.7
45 - 49	70.0	95.1	45.2
50 - 54	65.8	91.2	43.9
55 - 59	61.6	85.4	41.1
60+	29.3	47.2	14.6

Figure 1: Distribution of economically active vs inactive population, second quarter 2025



Considering the Table 4, the distribution of LFPR by age group and by gender depicts high male participation compared to female in all age groups. The highest participation rate for male is reported from age group 40 - 44 years (95.3%), while that for female is reported from 25 - 29 age group (47.8%).

Employment**Employed**

Persons, who worked at least one hour during the reference period, as paid employees, employers, own account workers or contributing family workers are said to be employed. This also includes persons with a job but not at work during the reference period.

Employment Rate

The proportion of employed population to the total labour force.

Table 5: Distribution of employed population by main industry (second quarter 2024 - second quarter 2025)

Quarter	Sri Lanka	Major Industry Group		
		Agriculture	Industries	Services
2024 Q2	7,988,626	2,000,744	2,116,002	3,871,880
(%)	100.0	25.0	26.5	48.5
2024 Q3	7,838,793	2,066,789	1,988,578	3,783,426
(%)	100.0	26.4	25.4	48.3
2024 Q4	8,069,891	2,159,496	2,071,302	3,839,094
(%)	100.0	26.8	25.7	47.6
2025 Q1	8,139,605	1,906,832	2,135,102	4,097,671
(%)	100.0	23.4	26.2	50.3
2025 Q2	8,172,638	2,104,353	2,063,914	4,004,372
(%)	100.0	25.7	25.3	49.0

Table 5 shows the percentage distribution of employed population by main industry from second quarter 2024 to second quarter 2025. During second quarter of 2025, the total number of employed persons in Sri Lanka is estimated as 8.2 million. Of which, about 49.0 percent engaged in service sector, 25.7 percent in agriculture sector and 25.3 percent in industry sector. In the second quarter of 2025, there are increases in employed persons in agriculture and service sectors compared to the second quarter of 2024.

Main industry categories and sub sectors

Agriculture

Agriculture, Forestry and Fishery (A)

Industries

1. Mining & Quarrying (B)
2. Manufacturing (C)
3. Construction, Electricity, gas, steam and air conditioning supply, Water supply, sewerage, waste management and remediation activities (D, E, F)

Services

1. Wholesale and retail trade, repair of motor vehicles and motor cycles (G)
2. Transportation and storage (H)
3. Accommodation and food services activities (I)
4. Information and communication (J)
5. Financial and insurance activities (K)
6. Professional, scientific and technical activities (M)
7. Administrative and support service activities (N)
8. Public administration and defence compulsory social security (O)
9. Education (P)
10. Human health and social work activities (Q)
11. Other service activities (S)
12. Activities of households as employers; undifferentiated goods and services - producing activities of households for own use (T)
13. Real estate activities (L) Arts, entertainment and recreation (R) Activities of extra territorial organizations & bodies (U)

Table 6: Distribution of employed population by employment status in agriculture and non - agriculture sectors, second quarter - 2025

Employment Status	Sector					
	Sri Lanka		Agriculture		Non-Agriculture	
	No.	%	No.	%	No.	%
Sri Lanka	8,172,638	100.0	2,104,353	25.7	6,068,285	74.3
Employee	4,979,407	100.0	807,727	16.2	4,171,680	83.8
Public	1,165,094	100.0	11,951*	1.0	1,153,143	99.0
Private	3,814,313	100.0	795,776	20.9	3,018,537	79.1
Employer	267,556	100.0	39,981	14.9	227,575	85.1
Own Account Worker	2,538,505	100.0	1,043,104	41.1	1,495,401	58.9
Contributing Family Worker	387,171	100.0	213,541	55.2	173,630	44.8

*These Figures are to be treated with caution as the corresponding CV (Coefficient of Variation) Values are high.

According to the Table 6 Majority of the workforce are private sector employees followed by own account workers. Non agriculture sector covers 74.3 percent of employed population in Sri Lanka, employees and own account workers are highly constraining in that sector.

Table 7 depicts the percentage distribution of male and female employed population by main industry sectors. Highest employment share is in service sector and this is true for both male & female, while the lowest shares are for industry sector. Among employed females 24.5 percent is in agriculture sector while this share is 26.4 percent for males.

Figure 2 : Distribution of employed population by employment status and Agriculture/ Non- Agriculture sector, second quarter - 2025

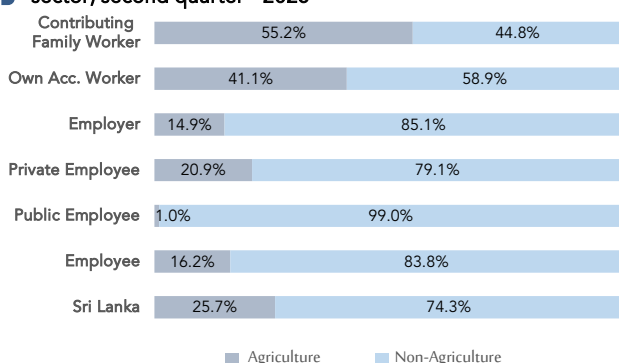


Table 7: Percentage distribution of Employed population by major industry group & gender, second quarter – 2025

Major Industry group	Sri Lanka	Gender	
		Male	Female
Sri Lanka	100.0	100.0	100.0
Agriculture	25.7	26.4	24.5
Industry	25.3	26.2	23.4
Services	49.0	47.5	52.1

Unemployment

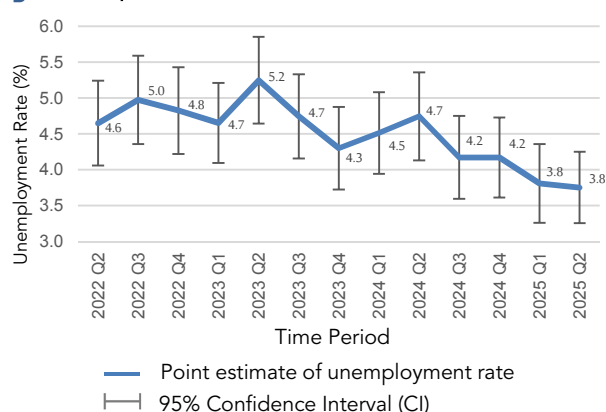
Unemployed

Persons available and/or looking for work, and who did not work and taken steps to find a job during last four weeks and ready to accept a job given a work opportunity within next two weeks are defined as be unemployed.

Unemployment Rate

The proportion of unemployed population to the total labour force.

Figure 3 : Unemployment rates and it's 95% confidence intervals, 2022Q2 - 2025Q2



The number of unemployed persons is estimated as 318,657 during the second quarter 2025. The unemployment rate for the second quarter 2025 is 3.8 percent.

As shown in Figure 3, it is very important to note that, when the changes in unemployment rate is explained the corresponding sampling errors¹ and the confidence limits need to be considered.

Table 8: Number of unemployed and unemployment rate by age group and gender, second quarter - 2025

Age group (Years)	Unemployment Rate (%)			
	Sri Lanka	Gender		
	Number	Sri Lanka	Male	Female
Sri Lanka	318,657	3.8	2.6	6.0
15 - 24	161,652	20.8	17.5	26.2
25 - 29	75,786	9.3	5.1*	17.0
Over 30	81,219	1.2	0.7*	2.1

*These Figures are to be treated with caution as the corresponding CV (Coefficient of Variation) Values are high.

1 Sampling error

When a sample, rather than the entire population, is surveyed, estimates differ from the true values of population they represent. This difference, or sampling error, occurs by chance, and its variability is measured by the sampling error of the estimate.

For more details, please refer the explanatory note given under the labour force link in the DCS website; www.statistics.gov.lk

Figure 4 : Unemployment rate by age group and gender, second quarter 2025



As per the table 8, overall unemployment rate reported for female is 6.0 percent and it is 2.6 percent for male. Youth unemployment rate (age 15 – 24 years) corresponding to the second quarter 2025 is 20.8 percent and that is the highest reported unemployment rate among all age groups. Further the unemployment rates for males and females are 17.5 and 26.2 percent respectively for age group 15 - 24.

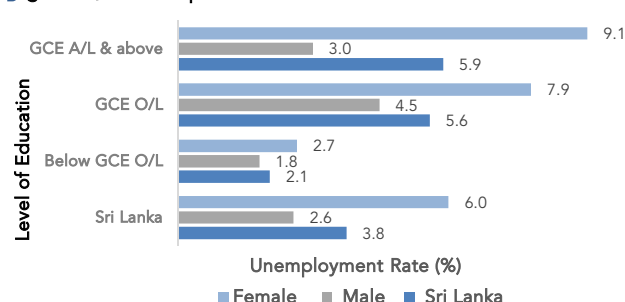
The survey results further reveals that the unemployment among females is higher than that of males, in all age groups. Youth and female unemployment contribute more to the overall unemployment of the country.

Table 9: Number of unemployed and unemployment rate by level of education, second quarter - 2025

Level of Education	Unemployment Rate (%)			
	Sri Lanka	Gender		
	Number	Sri Lanka	Male	Female
Sri Lanka	318,657	3.8	2.6	6.0
Below GCE O/L	94,783	2.1	1.8	2.7*
GCE O/L	87,743	5.6	4.5	7.9
GCE A/L & above	136,131	5.9	3.0	9.1

*These Figures are to be treated with caution as the corresponding CV (Coefficient of Variation) Values are high.

Figure 5 : Unemployment rate by level of education and gender, second quarter 2025



The highest unemployment rate is reported from the G.C.E.(A/L) and above group which is 5.9 percent. Corresponding percentages are 3.0 percent and 9.1 percent for males and females respectively. Female unemployment rates are higher than those of males in all levels of education.

Survey results further shows that the problem of unemployment is more acute in the case of educated females than educated males, which was observed consistently over the results of previous survey rounds as well.

Table 1 – Historical table of labour force status (current) of the household population, 15 years of age and over - Both sexes

Year	Household population: (15 years & over)	Labour force						Not in labour force Number
		Total labour force	Labour force partici: rate (%)	Employed		Unemployed		
				Number	Rate (% to total labour force)	Number	Rate (% to total labour force)	
2016	15,448,679	8,310,682	53.8	7,947,683	95.6	362,999	4.4	7,137,997
2017	15,843,735	8,566,686	54.1	8,208,179	95.8	358,507	4.2	7,277,049
2018	16,196,232	8,387,759	51.8	8,015,166	95.6	372,593	4.4	7,808,473
2019	16,424,016	8,592,010	52.3	8,180,693	95.2	411,318	4.8	7,832,006
2020	16,739,396	8,466,606	50.6	7,999,093	94.5	467,513	5.5	8,272,790
2021	17,133,659	8,553,290	49.9	8,113,507	94.9	439,783	5.1	8,580,369
2022	17,161,973	8,547,062	49.8	8,147,731	95.3	399,332	4.7	8,614,911
2023	17,306,492	8,408,331	48.6	8,009,916	95.3	398,415	4.7	8,898,161
2024	17,547,864	8,315,702	47.4	7,949,751	95.6	365,951	4.4	9,232,162
2023Q2	17,411,969	8,458,175	48.6	8,014,492	94.8	443,683	5.2	8,953,794
2024Q2	17,548,937	8,386,482	47.8	7,988,626	95.3	397,855	4.7	9,162,455
2025Q1	17,032,793	8,461,936	49.7	8,139,605	96.2	322,331	3.8	8,570,857
2025Q2	17,214,317	8,491,296	49.3	8,172,638	96.2	318,657	3.8	8,723,021

Table 1 A– Historical table of labour force status (current) of the household population, 15 years of age and over - Male

Year	Household population: (15 years & over)	Labour force						Not in labour force Number
		Total labour force	Labour force partici: rate (%)	Employed		Unemployed		
				Number	Rate (% to total labour force)	Number	Rate (% to total labour force)	
2016	7,064,736	5,303,502	75.1	5,149,948	97.1	153,554	2.9	1,761,234
2017	7,292,047	5,434,510	74.5	5,279,158	97.1	155,352	2.9	1,857,537
2018	7,488,320	5,464,236	73.0	5,300,310	97.0	163,926	3.0	2,024,084
2019	7,610,113	5,554,192	73.0	5,368,896	96.7	185,296	3.3	2,055,920
2020	7,788,634	5,598,004	71.9	5,372,947	96.0	225,057	4.0	2,190,629
2021	7,915,659	5,621,223	71.0	5,414,280	96.3	206,943	3.7	2,294,436
2022	7,914,636	5,580,786	70.5	5,373,965	96.3	206,822	3.7	2,333,850
2023	8,024,760	5,503,595	68.6	5,307,563	96.4	196,032	3.6	2,521,164
2024	8,195,169	5,525,402	67.4	5,358,554	97.0	166,849	3.0	2,669,766
2023Q2	8,065,309	5,552,332	68.8	5,323,491	95.9	228,841	4.1	2,512,977
2024Q2	8,194,669	5,580,419	68.1	5,379,472	96.4	200,947	3.6	2,614,250
2025Q1	7,905,930	5,538,301	70.1	5,399,400	97.5	138,901	2.5	2,367,630
2025Q2	8,049,609	5,590,609	69.5	5,446,537	97.4	144,071	2.6	2,459,000

Table 1B – Historical table of labour force status (current) of the household population, 15 years of age and over - Female

Year	Household population: (15 years & over)	Labour force						Not in labour force Number
		Total labour force	Labour force partici: rate (%)	Employed		Unemployed		
				Number	Rate (% to total labour force)	Number	Rate (% to total labour force)	
2016	8,383,943	3,007,180	35.9	2,797,735	93.0	209,445	7.0	5,376,764
2017	8,551,688	3,132,176	36.6	2,929,021	93.5	203,155	6.5	5,419,512
2018	8,707,912	2,923,523	33.6	2,714,855	92.9	208,667	7.1	5,784,390
2019	8,813,903	3,037,818	34.5	2,811,796	92.6	226,022	7.4	5,776,085
2020	8,950,763	2,868,602	32.0	2,626,146	91.5	242,456	8.5	6,082,161
2021	9,218,000	2,932,067	31.8	2,699,228	92.1	232,840	7.9	6,285,933
2022	9,247,337	2,966,276	32.1	2,773,766	93.5	192,510	6.5	6,281,061
2023	9,281,733	2,904,736	31.3	2,702,354	93.0	202,382	7.0	6,376,997
2024	9,352,695	2,790,299	29.8	2,591,197	92.9	199,102	7.1	6,562,395
2023Q2	9,346,660	2,905,844	31.1	2,691,001	92.6	214,842	7.4	6,440,817
2024Q2	9,354,267	2,806,062	30.0	2,609,154	93.0	196,908	7.0	6,548,205
2025Q1	9,126,863	2,923,635	32.0	2,740,205	93.7	183,430	6.3	6,203,228
2025Q2	9,164,708	2,900,687	31.7	2,726,101	94.0	174,586	6.0	6,264,021

Table 2 - Labour force status (current) of the household population 15 years of age and over, by age – Both sexes

Age	Household population: (15 years & over)	Labour force						Not in labour force Number
		Total labour force	Labour force partici: rate (%)	Employed		Unemployed		
				Number	Rate	Number	Rate	
					(% to total labour force)		(% to total labour force)	
All ages	17,214,317	8,491,296	49.3	8,172,638	96.2	318,657	3.8	8,723,021
15 – 19 Yrs	1,831,860	138,053	7.5	101,797	73.7	36,256	26.3	1,693,807
20 – 24 Yrs	1,417,409	639,990	45.2	514,594	80.4	125,396	19.6	777,419
25 – 29 Yrs	1,200,344	815,421	67.9	739,635	90.7	75,786	9.3	384,922
30 – 39 Yrs	2,560,285	1,703,722	66.5	1,657,798	97.3	45,924	2.7	856,563
40+ Yrs	10,204,418	5,194,109	50.9	5,158,814	99.3	35,294	0.7	5,010,310

Table 2A - Labour force status (current) of the household population 15 years of age and over, by age – Male

Age	Household population: (15 years & over)	Labour force						Not in labour force Number
		Total labour force	Labour force partici: rate (%)	Employed		Unemployed		
				Number	Rate	Number	Rate	
					(% to total labour force)		(% to total labour force)	
All ages	8,049,609	5,590,609	69.5	5,446,537	97.4	144,071	2.6	2,459,000
15 – 19 Yrs	917,860	97,725	10.6	75,537	77.3	22,188	22.7	820,135
20 – 24 Yrs	659,986	389,737	59.1	326,472	83.8	63,266	16.2	270,249
25 – 29 Yrs	598,515	527,828	88.2	501,032	94.9	26,795	5.1	70,687
30 – 39 Yrs	1,138,569	1,075,911	94.5	1,060,703	98.6	15,209	1.4	62,657
40+ Yrs	4,734,679	3,499,407	73.9	3,482,794	99.5	16,614	0.5	1,235,272

Table 2B - Labour force status (current) of the household population 15 years of age and over, by age – Female

Age	Household population: (15 years & over)	Labour force						Not in labour force Number
		Total labour force	Labour force partici: rate (%)	Employed		Unemployed		
				Number	Rate	Number	Rate	
					(% to total labour force)		(% to total labour force)	
All ages	9,164,708	2,900,687	31.7	2,726,101	94.0	174,586	6.0	6,264,021
15 – 19 Yrs	914,000	40,328	4.4	26,260	65.1	14,068	34.9	873,672
20 – 24 Yrs	757,423	250,253	33.0	188,123	75.2	62,131	24.8	507,170
25 – 29 Yrs	601,829	287,594	47.8	238,603	83.0	48,991	17.0	314,235
30 – 39 Yrs	1,421,716	627,811	44.2	597,095	95.1	30,716	4.9	793,905
40+ Yrs	5,469,739	1,694,702	31.0	1,676,021	98.9	18,681	1.1	3,775,038

These figures are to be treated with caution as the corresponding CV (Coefficient of variation) values are high.

Table 3 – Historical table of currently employed persons by age groups (Percentage) - Both sexes

Year	All ages	Age groups				
		15 – 19 Yrs	20 – 24 Yrs	25 – 29 Yrs	30 – 39 Yrs	40+ Yrs
2018	100.0	1.8	7.2	9.0	22.6	59.4
2019	100.0	1.9	7.1	9.3	22.6	59.1
2020	100.0	1.7	6.8	9.2	22.0	60.2
2021	100.0	1.4	6.3	9.4	21.1	61.8
2022	100.0	1.3	6.5	9.0	21.4	61.8
2023	100.0	1.2	6.4	8.4	20.3	63.7
2024	100.0	1.3	6.3	8.7	19.7	64.0
2023Q2	100.0	1.0	6.5	8.6	20.5	63.3
2024Q2	100.0	1.4	6.2	8.6	19.5	64.3
2025Q1	100.0	1.2	6.6	8.7	21.4	62.0
2025Q2	100.0	1.2	6.3	9.1	20.3	63.1

Table 3A – Historical table of currently employed persons by age groups (Percentage) - Male

Year	All ages	Age groups				
		15 – 19 Yrs	20 – 24 Yrs	25 – 29 Yrs	30 – 39 Yrs	40+ Yrs
2018	100.0	2.0	7.3	9.4	22.6	58.7
2019	100.0	2.1	7.2	9.4	22.3	59.0
2020	100.0	1.9	7.0	9.1	21.8	60.3
2021	100.0	1.6	6.4	9.4	20.5	62.0
2022	100.0	1.3	6.4	9.1	21.2	62.0
2023	100.0	1.4	6.4	8.4	20.0	63.9
2024	100.0	1.4	6.4	8.6	19.3	64.4
2023Q2	100.0	1.1	6.8	8.5	20.2	63.3
2024Q2	100.0	1.5	6.5	8.4	19.3	64.4
2025Q1	100.0	1.2	6.4	8.9	21.6	61.9
2025Q2	100.0	1.4	6.0	9.2	19.5	63.9

Table 3B – Historical table of currently employed persons by age groups (Percentage) - Female

Year	All ages	Age groups				
		15 – 19 Yrs	20 – 24 Yrs	25 – 29 Yrs	30 – 39 Yrs	40+ Yrs
2018	100.0	1.4	6.9	8.3	22.7	60.7
2019	100.0	1.4	7.0	9.1	23.1	59.4
2020	100.0	1.4	6.5	9.3	22.6	60.1
2021	100.0	1.1	6.0	9.3	22.3	61.4
2022	100.0	1.1	6.8	8.9	21.8	61.4
2023	100.0	0.8	6.4	8.4	20.9	63.4
2024	100.0	1.0	6.1	9.1	20.7	63.1
2023Q2	100.0	0.7	5.9	8.8	21.2	63.3
2024Q2	100.0	1.3	5.6	9.2	19.9	64.0
2025Q1	100.0	1.2	6.9	8.4	21.2	62.4
2025Q2	100.0	1.0	6.9	8.8	21.9	61.5

These figures are to be treated with caution as the corresponding CV (Coefficient of variation) values are high.

Table 4 – Historical table of currently employed persons by level of education (Percentage) - Both sexes

Year	Total	Level of education			
		Grade 5 & Below	Grades 6 - 10	GCE (O.L)/ NCGE	GCE (A.L)/ HNCE & above
2019	100.0	14.0	45.8	17.4	22.8
2020	100.0	13.7	46.0	17.8	22.5
2021	100.0	13.0	45.7	17.6	23.8
2022	100.0	12.7	45.1	17.6	24.6
2023	100.0	12.6	43.9	18.5	25.1
2024	100.0	11.6	43.6	19.1	25.6
2023Q2	100.0	13.2	43.2	17.8	25.8
2024Q2	100.0	12.5	42.8	19.0	25.7
2025Q1	100.0	11.8	41.9	19.6	26.7
2025Q2	100.0	11.9	43.4	18.1	26.6

Table 4A – Historical table of currently employed persons by level of education (Percentage) - Male

Year	Total	Level of education			
		Grade 5 & Below	Grades 6 - 10	GCE (O.L)/ NCGE	GCE (A.L)/ HNCE & above
2019	100.0	14.1	49.6	18.0	18.2
2020	100.0	13.8	49.8	18.3	18.1
2021	100.0	13.0	49.6	18.6	18.8
2022	100.0	13.0	49.1	18.5	19.4
2023	100.0	12.9	48.0	19.2	19.9
2024	100.0	12.0	47.7	19.9	20.5
2023Q2	100.0	13.5	47.2	18.7	20.6
2024Q2	100.0	12.8	47.0	19.6	20.6
2025Q1	100.0	11.8	46.0	20.2	22.0
2025Q2	100.0	11.8	48.3	18.4	21.6

Table 4B – Historical table of currently employed persons by level of education (Percentage) - Female

Year	Total	Level of education			
		Grade 5 & Below	Grades 6 - 10	GCE (O.L)/ NCGE	GCE (A.L)/ HNCE & above
2019	100.0	13.8	38.4	16.3	31.6
2020	100.0	13.4	38.1	16.8	31.7
2021	100.0	12.8	37.8	15.5	33.8
2022	100.0	12.0	37.2	16.1	34.7
2023	100.0	12.0	35.8	17.0	35.3
2024	100.0	10.8	35.3	17.6	36.3
2023Q2	100.0	12.7	35.4	15.9	36.0
2024Q2	100.0	11.9	34.1	17.7	36.3
2025Q1	100.0	11.9	33.7	18.4	36.0
2025Q2	100.0	12.2	33.8	17.5	36.5

Table 5 – Historical table of currently employed persons by employment status (Percentage) - Both sexes

Year	Total employed	Employee			Employer	Own account worker	Unpaid family worker
		Total	Public	Private			
2019	100.0	57.9	14.9	43.0	2.6	32.5	7.0
2020	100.0	57.5	14.8	42.7	2.5	33.2	6.8
2021	100.0	57.3	15.2	42.0	2.7	33.4	6.6
2022	100.0	58.0	15.1	42.9	2.9	33.1	5.9
2023	100.0	59.0	14.6	44.5	2.6	32.8	5.5
2024	100.0	58.8	14.4	44.4	2.9	33.1	5.2
2023Q2	100.0	59.1	14.7	44.4	2.8	32.3	5.8
2024Q2	100.0	59.0	14.4	44.6	3.3	33.0	4.8
2025Q1	100.0	62.8	16.0	46.8	2.9	30.2	4.2
2025Q2	100.0	60.9	14.3	46.7	3.3	31.1	4.7

Table 5A – Historical table of currently employed persons by employment status (Percentage) - Male

Year	Total employed	Employee			Employer	Own account worker	Unpaid family worker
		Total	Public	Private			
2019	100.0	57.7	12.2	45.5	3.5	36.5	2.3
2020	100.0	56.7	12.0	44.7	3.4	37.5	2.4
2021	100.0	56.6	12.1	44.4	3.7	37.3	2.4
2022	100.0	57.0	11.9	45.1	3.9	37.2	2.0
2023	100.0	57.6	11.5	46.1	3.5	36.8	2.1
2024	100.0	57.2	11.2	46.0	3.8	37.1	1.9
2023Q2	100.0	57.9	11.7	46.2	3.7	35.9	2.5
2024Q2	100.0	57.2	11.4	45.8	4.4	36.6	1.8
2025Q1	100.0	61.4	12.9	48.5	3.8	33.5	1.3
2025Q2	100.0	58.6	11.4	47.2	4.4	35.1	1.9

Table 5B – Historical table of currently employed persons by employment status (Percentage) - Female

Year	Total employed	Employee			Employer	Own account worker	Unpaid family worker
		Total	Public	Private			
2019	100.0	58.3	19.9	38.4	0.8	24.8	16.1
2020	100.0	59.0	20.5	38.5	0.8	24.4	15.8
2021	100.0	58.7	21.5	37.2	0.8	25.4	15.2
2022	100.0	60.0	21.3	38.7	1.0	25.4	13.6
2023	100.0	61.9	20.6	41.2	0.9	25.0	12.2
2024	100.0	62.2	21.2	41.0	1.1	24.9	11.9
2023Q2	100.0	61.5	20.6	40.9	0.9	25.2	12.4
2024Q2	100.0	62.7	20.4	42.3	1.0	25.4	10.8
2025Q1	100.0	65.5	22.1	43.4	1.1	23.6	9.8
2025Q2	100.0	65.6	19.9	45.7	0.9	23.1	10.4

These figures are to be treated with caution as the corresponding CV (Coefficient of variation) values are high.

Table 6 - Currently Employed person by Industry group (Based on ISIC Fourth Revision) - both sexes

Year	Total	Industry Group																
		1	2	3	6	7	8	9	10	11	13	14	15	16	17	19	20	Other
2021	8,113,507	2,213,015	54,586	1,362,311	692,585	1,153,516	481,703	214,497	72,881	182,313	80,762	136,073	490,106	423,135	174,539	128,418	201,726	51,342
2022	8,147,731	2,158,559	58,979	1,408,819	690,401	1,142,754	486,346	235,544	71,054	182,379	87,337	146,494	456,844	461,829	169,298	162,099	157,590	71,404
2023	8,009,916	2,088,344	64,606	1,377,686	600,862	1,127,497	504,645	277,739	78,347	176,891	89,946	135,523	438,156	429,311	185,014	209,128	160,913	65,308
2024	7,949,751	2,066,651	60,445	1,366,492	604,479	1,175,059	521,450	259,043	80,357	158,144	85,106	147,556	419,058	422,348	183,209	200,086	138,315	61,951
2023Q2	8,014,492	2,058,421	76,369	1,448,216	579,664	1,161,025	491,912	257,061	81,927	168,149	101,302	124,748	438,598	424,179	166,729	209,377	171,564	55,252
2024Q2	7,988,626	2,000,744	60,339	1,454,158	601,505	1,182,393	489,853	257,506	85,569	156,510	95,425	158,947	425,039	425,473	173,637	205,640	149,653	66,236
2025Q1	8,139,605	1,906,832	58,592	1,442,248	634,261	1,149,546	497,674	276,082	102,655	224,863	103,823	175,445	450,783	462,818	198,096	208,072	184,463	63,352
2025Q2	8,172,638	2,104,353	38,061	1,389,082	636,771	1,139,588	486,366	288,978	80,091	192,699	101,481	141,616	470,358	447,445	168,392	212,615	204,412	70,331

Table 6A - Currently Employed person by Industry group (Based on ISIC Fourth Revision) - Male

Year	Total	Industry Group																
		1	2	3	6	7	8	9	10	11	13	14	15	16	17	19	20	Other
2021	5,414,280	1,423,619	53,512	775,837	663,925	834,545	465,940	136,349	51,631	108,793	49,777	96,394	290,754	127,846	63,616	96,710	134,475	40,557
2022	5,373,965	1,422,010	58,657	758,623	658,525	831,372	466,203	141,812	48,341	100,235	55,248	104,400	271,425	139,674	61,720	123,033	79,292	53,396
2023	5,307,563	1,418,583	62,801	731,875	574,746	823,014	480,265	167,045	60,945	97,742	57,625	92,927	270,067	127,997	59,902	167,068	62,929	52,031
2024	5,358,554	1,446,096	59,637	737,824	573,276	861,799	498,811	167,564	56,051	89,841	55,073	104,679	253,211	138,581	56,349	158,330	54,071	47,360
2023Q2	5,323,491	1,401,382	76,369	776,085	547,264	842,369	466,425	154,340	62,651	95,831	67,598	84,486	281,692	119,959	54,321	167,005	80,424	45,289
2024Q2	5,379,472	1,424,001	60,339	775,013	580,303	847,189	461,997	171,167	63,801	91,970	55,409	112,321	262,600	135,737	57,446	161,030	62,215	56,934
2025Q1	5,399,400	1,316,064	57,011	770,705	609,300	829,968	474,558	168,761	73,630	121,101	60,610	124,617	258,569	160,587	82,893	160,302	84,235	46,488
2025Q2	5,446,537	1,435,970	38,061	778,928	608,166	849,992	466,046	178,320	60,304	93,166	64,115	91,272	292,077	118,205	67,047	162,105	86,457	56,306

Table 6B - Currently Employed person by Industry group (Based on ISIC Fourth Revision) - Female

Year	Total	Industry Group																
		1	2	3	6	7	8	9	10	11	13	14	15	16	17	19	20	Other
2021	2,699,228	789,396	1,074	586,474	28,660	318,971	15,763	78,147	21,250	73,519	30,985	39,679	199,352	295,289	110,923	31,708	67,251	10,785
2022	2,773,766	736,549	322	650,196	31,877	311,382	20,144	93,732	22,712	82,144	32,089	42,094	185,419	322,155	107,578	39,066	78,298	18,009
2023	2,702,354	669,761	1,805	645,812	26,116	304,483	24,381	110,694	17,401	79,150	32,321	42,595	168,089	301,314	125,112	42,060	97,984	13,277
2024	2,591,197	620,555	809	628,668	31,203	313,260	22,639	91,479	24,306	68,303	30,034	42,877	165,847	283,767	126,859	41,756	84,244	14,591
2023Q2	2,691,001	657,039	..	672,131	32,400	318,656	25,487	102,721	19,276	72,318	33,704	40,263	156,906	304,220	112,408	42,371	91,140	9,962
2024Q2	2,609,154	576,743	..	679,144	21,202	335,204	27,855	86,339	21,767	64,539	40,016	46,626	162,439	289,736	116,191	44,610	87,438	9,303
2025Q1	2,740,205	590,768	1,581	671,543	24,961	319,578	23,116	107,321	29,024	103,762	43,213	50,828	192,214	302,231	115,203	47,769	100,228	16,864
2025Q2	2,726,101	668,383	..	610,154	28,605	289,597	20,320	110,658	19,787	99,532	37,367	50,344	178,281	329,240	101,345	50,510	117,954	14,024

These figures are to be treated with caution as the corresponding CV (Coefficient of variation) values are high.

.. Not reported

Note: These Industry groups are based on ISIC - Rev. 4

1 Agriculture, forestry and fishing (A)

2 Mining & quarrying (B)

3 Manufacturing (C)

6 Construction, Electricity, gas, steam and air conditioning supply, Water supply, sewerage, waste management and remediation activities (D, E, F)

7 Wholesale and retail trade, repair of motor vehicles and motor cycles (G)

8 Transportation and storage (H)

9 Accommodation and food services activities (I)

10 Information and communication (J)

11 Financial and insurance activities (K)

13 Professional, scientific and technical activities (M)

14 Administrative and support service activities (N)

15 Public administration and defence compulsory social security (O)

16 Education (P)

17 Human health and social work activities (Q)

19 Other service activities (S)

20 Activities of households as employers; undifferentiated goods and services - producing activities of households for own use (T)

Other

Other

12 Real estate activities (L)

18 Arts, entertainment and recreation (R)

21 Activities of extra territorial organizations & bodies (U)

Table 6C: Historical table of currently employed population by major industry group - Both sexes

Major Industry Group	Year							
	2021	2022	2023	2024	2023Q2	2024Q2	2025Q1	2025Q2
Total	8,113,507	8,147,731	8,009,916	7,949,751	8,014,492	7,988,626	8,139,605	8,172,638
Agriculture	2,213,015	2,158,559	2,088,344	2,066,651	2,058,421	2,000,744	1,906,832	2,104,353
Industry	2,109,482	2,158,199	2,043,154	2,031,417	2,104,249	2,116,002	2,135,102	2,063,914
Services	3,791,011	3,830,973	3,878,418	3,851,683	3,851,822	3,871,880	4,097,671	4,004,372

Table 6D: Historical table of currently employed population by major industry group (percentage) - Both sexes

Major Industry Group	Year							
	2021	2022	2023	2024	2023Q2	2024Q2	2025Q1	2025Q2
Total	100.0	100.0	100.0	100.0	100.0	100.0	100.0	100.0
Agriculture	27.3	26.5	26.1	26.0	25.7	25.0	23.4	25.7
Industry	26.0	26.5	25.5	25.6	26.3	26.5	26.2	25.3
Services	46.7	47.0	48.4	48.5	48.1	48.5	50.3	49.0

Note: These Industry groups are based on ISIC - Rev. 4

Agriculture

1. Agriculture Forestry and Fishery (A)

Industries

1. Mining & Quarrying (B)
2. Manufacturing (C)
3. Construction, Electricity, gas, steam and air conditioning supply, Water supply, sewerage, waste management and remediation activities (D, E,F)

Services

1. Wholesale and retail trade, repair of motor vehicles and motor cycles(G)
2. Transportation and storage (H)
3. Accommodation and food services activities (I)
4. Information and communication (J)
5. Financial and insurance activities (K)
6. Professional, scientific and technical activities (M)
7. Administrative and support service activities (N)
8. Public administration and defence compulsory social security (O)
9. Education (P)
10. Human health and social work activities (Q)
11. Other service activities (S)
12. Activities of households as employers; undifferentiated goods and services - producing activities of households for own use (T)
13. Real estate activities (L) Arts, entertainment and recreation (R) Activities of extra territorial organizations & bodies (U)

Table 7 - Currently Employed person by Occupation group (Based on ISCO 08) - Both sexes

Year	Total	Occupation group									
		1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	0
2020	7,999,093	512,087	531,298	695,206	306,448	756,851	1,373,582	1,222,380	729,394	1,833,523	38,325
2021	8,113,507	324,769	576,124	681,988	282,448	947,824	1,308,645	1,142,171	816,954	2,000,483	32,101
2022	8,147,731	340,894	596,432	688,341	296,177	901,590	1,310,662	1,173,642	786,507	2,007,366	46,120
2023	8,009,916	320,025	587,902	690,537	262,986	984,747	1,211,408	1,105,729	759,785	2,056,729	30,068
2024	7,949,751	339,787	589,418	686,022	283,293	978,857	1,212,157	1,077,931	783,781	1,957,410	41,094
2023Q2	8,014,492	331,481	556,672	736,734	269,226	970,963	1,194,059	1,115,112	718,826	2,097,342	24,078
2024Q2	7,988,626	334,376	577,877	683,824	272,126	1,043,545	1,170,331	1,131,565	778,460	1,951,583	44,938
2025Q1	8,139,605	388,842	678,169	811,994	258,907	990,920	1,074,089	1,092,217	776,946	2,012,828	54,693
2025Q2	8,172,638	356,842	613,833	780,828	245,266	1,033,478	1,136,318	1,093,878	743,483	2,133,468	35,244

Table 7A - Currently Employed person by Occupation group (Based on ISCO 08) - Male

Year	Total	Occupation group									
		1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	0
2020	5,372,947	373,757	191,282	452,640	140,458	540,840	984,507	883,796	617,644	1,154,222	33,801
2021	5,414,280	261,533	211,883	440,246	133,690	639,288	981,016	843,075	644,676	1,228,363	30,511
2022	5,373,965	264,794	215,652	437,218	141,818	606,381	956,970	835,321	622,142	1,252,138	41,531
2023	5,307,563	252,648	226,462	422,132	118,267	673,020	926,474	770,046	599,409	1,290,760	28,345
2024	5,358,554	249,813	220,360	450,587	135,584	674,946	947,298	763,680	617,928	1,260,484	37,874
2023Q2	5,323,491	275,216	209,069	453,479	131,913	667,221	913,265	762,490	559,240	1,328,705	22,893
2024Q2	5,379,472	250,696	211,193	448,692	146,131	695,019	907,179	807,471	602,390	1,268,971	41,730
2025Q1	5,399,400	280,017	276,401	514,769	105,353	684,772	815,856	762,733	600,644	1,306,784	52,071
2025Q2	5,446,537	261,508	230,886	494,610	107,542	719,248	872,458	801,282	598,281	1,329,064	31,659

Table 7B - Currently Employed person by Occupation group (Based on ISCO 08) - Female

Year	Total	Occupation group									
		1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	0
2020	2,626,146	138,329	340,016	242,566	165,990	216,011	389,075	338,584	111,750	679,301	4,524
2021	2,699,228	63,236	364,242	241,742	148,758	308,536	327,629	299,096	172,278	772,120	1,590
2022	2,773,766	76,101	380,779	251,123	154,359	295,209	353,692	338,321	164,364	755,227	4,589
2023	2,702,354	67,378	361,440	268,406	144,719	311,727	284,934	335,682	160,376	765,969	1,723
2024	2,591,197	89,974	369,058	235,434	147,709	303,911	264,859	314,251	165,854	696,926	3,221
2023Q2	2,691,001	56,264	347,602	283,255	137,313	303,742	280,795	352,622	159,587	768,637	1,185
2024Q2	2,609,154	83,680	366,684	235,131	125,995	348,527	263,152	324,094	176,070	682,612	3,208
2025Q1	2,740,205	108,826	401,768	297,225	153,554	306,148	258,233	329,484	176,302	706,044	2,622
2025Q2	2,726,101	95,334	382,946	286,219	137,725	314,230	263,860	292,596	145,201	804,405	3,585

These figures are to be treated with caution as the corresponding CV (Coefficient of variation) values are high.

- 1 Managers, Senior Officials and Legislators
- 2 Professionals
- 3 Technicians and Associate Professionals
- 4 Clerks and Clerical support workers
- 5 Services and Sales workers

- 6 Skilled Agriculture, Forestry and Fishery workers
- 7 Craft and Related Trades workers
- 8 Plant and Machine operators and Assemblers
- 9 Elementary occupations
- 0 Armed Forces Occupations & unidentified occupations

Table 8 - Currently employed persons by hours per week actually worked at the main job and major industrial group (Percentage) - Both sexes

Major industrial group	Total	0 *	1 - 9	10 - 19	20 - 29	30 - 39	40 - 49	50 & Over
Total	100.0	3.7	2.3	5.7	9.2	15.7	34.4	28.9
1	100.0	3.8	4.5	10.4	15.4	23.7	28.9	13.4
2	100.0	19.4	..	..	3.9	6.5	33.0	37.2
3	100.0	4.9	1.6	5.7	8.7	10.9	37.8	30.5
6	100.0	8.1	1.7	4.5	9.5	12.8	39.7	23.7
7	100.0	1.3	0.9	2.4	4.9	9.6	30.2	50.6
8	100.0	1.2	1.4	3.5	5.7	11.1	29.3	47.7
9	100.0	2.5	3.1	6.4	7.5	10.4	26.6	43.6
10	100.0	2.1	1.7	3.5	2.5	6.6	50.3	33.2
11	100.0	..	2.2	2.6	8.5	3.5	58.7	24.5
13	100.0	1.2	..	3.9	8.6	9.9	52.1	24.3
14	100.0	2.6	1.7	1.5	2.2	9.6	41.1	41.3
15	100.0	1.8	0.7	1.7	3.4	5.4	57.5	29.4
16	100.0	8.6	2.7	3.9	8.4	44.8	25.8	5.8
17	100.0	..	..	1.0	4.9	7.4	39.2	47.5
19	100.0	2.8	2.7	5.3	10.9	13.5	25.7	39.1
20	100.0	2.9	2.7	8.7	7.6	19.9	28.2	29.9
Other	100.0	2.7	1.7	13.2	15.6	18.2	30.2	18.4

* Has a job but not at work during the reference week

.. Not reported

These figures are to be treated with caution as the corresponding CV (Coefficient of variation) values are high.

Industry group

1 Agriculture, forestry and fishing (A)

2 Mining & quarrying (B)

3 Manufacturing (C)

6 Construction, Electricity, gas, steam and air conditioning supply, Water supply, sewerage, waste management and remediation activities (D, E,F)

7 Wholesale and retail trade, repair of motor vehicles and motor cycles(G)

8 Transportation and storage (H)

9 Accommodation and food services activities (I)

10 Information and communication (J)

11 Financial and insurance activities (K)

13 Professional, scientific and technical activities (M)

14 Administrative and support service activities (N)

15 Public administration and defence compulsory social security (O)

16 Education (P)

17 Human health and social work activities (Q)

19 Other service activities (S)

20 Activities of households as employers; undifferentiated goods and services - producing activities of households for own use (T)

Other

Other

12 Real estate activities (L)

18 Arts, entertainment and recreation (R)

21 Activities of extra territorial organizations & bodies (U)

Table 9 – Historical table of currently unemployed persons by age groups (Percentage) - Both Sexes

Year	Total	Age groups				
		15 – 19 Yrs	20 – 24 Yrs	25 – 29 Yrs	30 – 39 Yrs	40 + Yrs
2018	100.0	14.1	38.9	22.5	15.0	9.5
2019	100.0	13.0	36.0	22.8	14.3	13.8
2020	100.0	13.5	39.3	21.5	13.8	12.0
2021	100.0	8.9	42.5	22.2	15.2	11.1
2022	100.0	9.6	37.2	24.4	14.1	14.7
2023	100.0	10.0	35.5	25.3	14.2	15.1
2024	100.0	10.6	35.7	27.1	15.6	10.9
2023Q2	100.0	14.0	33.1	20.4	15.1	17.3
2024Q2	100.0	13.5	38.3	22.0	14.6	11.5
2025Q1	100.0	11.3	37.0	24.8	15.7	11.1
2025Q2	100.0	11.4	39.4	23.8	14.4	11.1

Table 9A– Historical table of currently unemployed persons by age groups (Percentage) – Male

Year	Total	Age groups				
		15 – 19 Yrs	20 – 24 Yrs	25 – 29 Yrs	30 – 39 Yrs	40 + Yrs
2018	100.0	20.5	40.9	17.5	10.7	10.5
2019	100.0	18.3	38.9	19.5	8.3	15.0
2020	100.0	18.8	41.0	18.6	11.9	9.7
2021	100.0	12.3	45.0	20.0	12.1	10.6
2022	100.0	12.9	38.9	21.2	12.1	14.8
2023	100.0	13.8	36.6	21.5	12.2	15.8
2024	100.0	14.9	37.7	24.1	13.6	9.7
2023Q2	100.0	18.9	35.4	15.3	13.0	17.4
2024Q2	100.0	15.6	37.9	22.0	13.8	10.7
2025Q1	100.0	15.7	36.8	25.2	11.9	10.4
2025Q2	100.0	15.4	43.9	18.6	10.6	11.5

Table 9B – Historical table of currently unemployed persons by age groups (Percentage) – Female

Year	Total	Age groups				
		15 – 19 Yrs	20 – 24 Yrs	25 – 29 Yrs	30 – 39 Yrs	40 + Yrs
2018	100.0	9.1	37.3	26.5	18.4	8.7
2019	100.0	8.7	33.6	25.5	19.3	12.9
2020	100.0	8.5	37.7	24.1	15.6	14.1
2021	100.0	5.8	40.3	24.2	18.0	11.6
2022	100.0	6.1	35.2	27.7	16.3	14.6
2023	100.0	6.2	34.4	28.9	16.0	14.4
2024	100.0	7.0	34.0	29.7	17.4	11.9
2023Q2	100.0	8.8	30.7	25.9	17.4	17.2
2024Q2	100.0	11.4	38.8	21.9	15.4	12.4
2025Q1	100.0	7.9	37.2	24.6	18.6	11.6
2025Q2	100.0	8.1	35.6	28.1	17.6	10.7

These figures are to be treated with caution as the corresponding CV (Coefficient of variation) values are high.

Table 10 – Historical table of currently unemployed persons by level of education (Percentage) – Both sexes

Year	Total	Level of education			
		Grade 5 & below	Grades 6 - 10	GCE(O/L) NCGE	GCE(A/L) HNCE & Above
2018	100.0	2.2	30.5	21.4	45.8
2019	100.0	2.9	31.4	23.9	41.9
2020	100.0	2.2	32.6	23.5	41.7
2021	100.0	1.4	29.6	24.9	44.1
2022	100.0	1.8	32.1	23.6	42.6
2023	100.0	1.8	31.1	23.6	43.6
2024	100.0	1.4	26.9	25.0	46.8
2023Q2	100.0	3.0	32.9	23.6	40.5
2024Q2	100.0	2.4	30.8	23.2	43.6
2025Q1	100.0	1.5	26.3	28.7	43.5
2025Q2	100.0	2.8	26.9	27.5	42.7

Table 10A – Historical table of currently unemployed persons by level of education (Percentage) – Male

Year	Total	Level of education			
		Grade 5 & below	Grades 6 - 10	GCE(O/L) NCGE	GCE(A/L) HNCE & Above
2018	100.0	3.1	43.1	25.0	28.9
2019	100.0	2.9	42.2	27.0	28.0
2020	100.0	2.3	41.5	27.7	28.5
2021	100.0	1.8	36.0	29.9	32.3
2022	100.0	2.2	40.1	28.0	29.6
2023	100.0	2.3	39.3	25.1	33.4
2024	100.0	1.0	33.2	28.0	37.8
2023Q2	100.0	4.4	40.5	23.0	32.1
2024Q2	100.0	1.8	36.5	27.8	33.8
2024Q3	100.0	1.0	29.6	26.8	42.7
2024Q4	100.0	..	37.5	26.2	36.2
2025Q1	100.0	1.4	33.0	28.4	37.2
2025Q2	100.0	4.8	37.3	32.6	25.3

Table 10B – Historical table of currently unemployed persons by level of education (Percentage) – Female

Year	Total	Level of education			
		Grade 5 & below	Grades 6 - 10	GCE(O/L) NCGE	GCE(A/L) HNCE & Above
2018	100.0	1.5	20.6	18.7	59.2
2019	100.0	2.9	22.5	21.4	53.3
2020	100.0	2.2	24.2	19.7	53.9
2021	100.0	1.0	23.9	20.5	54.6
2022	100.0	1.3	23.5	18.8	56.4
2023	100.0	1.4	23.1	22.1	53.4
2024	100.0	1.7	21.5	22.4	54.4
2023Q2	100.0	1.6	24.7	24.2	49.4
2024Q2	100.0	3.0	25.0	18.5	53.5
2025Q1	100.0	1.6	21.2	28.9	48.3
2025Q2	100.0	1.2	18.4	23.3	57.1

These figures are to be treated with caution as the corresponding CV (Coefficient of variation) values are high.

.. Not reported

Table 11 – Currently unemployed persons by sex and duration of unemployment

(2025 2nd Quarter)

Sex	Total	Duration		
		Less than 6 months	6 to less than 12 months	12+ months
Both sexes	318,657	132,909	85,880	99,869
%	100.0	41.7	27.0	31.3
Male	144,071	62,829	40,419	40,823
%	100.0	43.6	28.1	28.3
Female	174,586	70,080	45,461	59,046
%	100.0	40.1	26.0	33.8

Table 12 – Standard error and coefficient of variation of selected variables

	Estimated Value	Standard Error	Coefficient of Variation (%)	Estimated Value (Ratio)	Standard Error	Coefficient of Variation (%)
General labour force characteristics						
Population (15 years & over)	17,214,317	134,808	0.8			
Employed Population	8,172,638	99,002	1.2			
Unemployed Population	318,657	22,132	6.9			
Employment Rate				96.2	0.25	0.26
Unemployment Rate				3.8	0.25	6.73
Labour Force	8,491,296	102,560	1.2			
Not in Labour Force	8,723,021	112,875	1.3			
Employed persons by major industry Groups						
1	2,104,353	83,501	4.0			
2	38,061	9,353	24.6			
3	1,389,082	53,789	3.9			
6	636,771	32,138	5.0			
7	1,139,588	48,524	4.3			
8	486,366	28,784	5.9			
9	288,978	25,346	8.8			
10	80,091	11,704	14.6			
11	192,699	18,567	9.6			
13	101,481	13,700	13.5			
14	141,616	16,809	11.9			
15	470,358	29,340	6.2			
16	447,445	27,395	6.1			
17	168,392	16,021	9.5			
19	212,615	18,778	8.8			
20	204,412	21,352	10.4			
Other	70,331	11,016	15.7			
Unemployed persons by level of education						
Below grade 6	9,078	3,758	41.4			
Grade 6 - 10	85,705	9,877	11.5			
G.C.E.(O/L)/N.C.G.E.	87,743	9,944	11.3			
G.C.E.(A/L)/H.N.C.E. & above	136,131	11,486	8.4			
Industry group						
1 Agriculture, forestry and fishing (A)						
2 Mining & quarrying (B)						
3 Manufacturing (C)						
6 Construction, Electricity, gas, steam and air conditioning supply, Water supply, sewerage, waste management and remediation activities (D, E,F)						
7 Wholesale and retail trade, repair of motor vehicles and motor cycles(G)						
8 Transportation and storage (H)						
9 Accommodation and food services activities (I)						
10 Information and communication (J)						
11 Financial and insurance activities (K)						
13 Professional, scientific and technical activities (M)						
14 Administrative and support service activities (N)						
15 Public administration and defence compulsory social security (O)						
16 Education (P)						
17 Human health and social work activities (Q)						
19 Other service activities (S)						
20 Activities of households as employers; undifferentiated goods and services - producing activities of households for own use (T)						
Other						
	Other					
	Real estate activities (L)					
	Arts, entertainment and recreation (R)					
	Activities of extra territorial organizations & bodies (U)					

Special Statistical Appendix

Explanatory Notes

Coverage

Sri Lanka Labour Force Survey was designed to measure the levels and trends of employment, unemployment and labour force in Sri Lanka. This survey is being conducted quarterly, since the first quarter of 1990.

This quarterly survey of households is conducted through a scientifically selected sample designed to represent the civilian non-institutional population. Respondents are interviewed to obtain information about the employment status etc. of each member of the household 15 years of age and older.

The field work of the survey is done during the third week of each month, Monday through Sunday. This is known as the "survey week". The inquiry relates to activity or status are referred in the preceding week of the survey week; referred to as the "reference week".

The concepts and definitions underlying labour force data are as follows.

Concepts & Definitions

1. **Labour force:** The labour force is composed of the economically active population 15 years of age and over.
2. **The Economically Active Population:** is defined as those persons who are/were employed or unemployed during the reference period of the survey.
3. **Employed:** Persons, who during the reference period, worked as paid employees, employers, own account workers (self employed), or unpaid family workers are said to be employed. This includes persons with a job but not at work during the reference period.
4. **Unemployed:** Persons who are seeking and available for work, but had no employment during the reference period.
5. **Currently Economically Active:** A person who was employed or unemployed during the current reference period is considered to be currently economically active.
6. **Not in the Labour Force (not economically active):** Persons who were neither working nor available/looking for work are classified as "not in the labour force". Persons are not in the labour force for such reasons as: full time care of the household, full – time students, retired or old age, infirmed or disabled, or are not interested in working for one reason or another. Current and Usual definitions apply.
7. **Criteria for classification of underemployment:** In order to classify an employed persons as visibly underemployed,

*Explanatory Notes (Page 2)****(i) If the person has worked less than the normal duration in his/her main activity***

In Sri Lanka scenario, 35 hours per week is taken as the cut-off point applicable to all workers, except government teachers. As in practice, though teachers do have a normal duration of work which is below the general cut-off point, they should be on a full time schedule according to the nature of their job. Further, those who do have a secondary job or those who are employers, were considered as having worked the normal duration in their respective activity.

Therefore, if the person has worked less than the normal duration in his/her activity (as described above), then the person is further questioned to ascertain whether he/She is prepared and available for further work if provided. Such persons are considered underemployed in their respective employment.

(ii) If the person has worked more than the normal duration in his/her activity

If the person has worked even more than 35 hours as usually, but he has worked less than 35 hours actually in the reference period, only due to the off season or bad weather, such persons were also further questioned to check their underemployment situation, considering them as a special category.

8. Informal Sector Employment

In order to classify a person to be employed in informal sector employment, following information were used.

- (i) Registration of the organization
- (ii) Accounts keeping practices of the organization
- (iii) Total number of regular employees of the organization.

Reliability of the estimates

Statistics based on the quarterly labour force data are subject to both sampling and non - sampling errors. When a sample rather than the entire population is surveyed, there is a chance that the sample estimates may differ from the "true" population values they represent.

The exact differences or sampling error, varies depending on the particular sample selected, and this variability is measured by the standard error of the estimate. There is about a 95 percent chance, or level of confidence, that an estimate based on a sample will differ by no more than 1.96 standard errors from the "true" population value, because of sampling error. Analyses relating to the Labour Force Survey are generally conducted at the 95 percent level of confidence.

For example, the confidence interval for the quarterly unemployment rate is calculated as follows

When the estimated unemployment rate is 4.5 and standard error of unemployment rate is 0.275 then 95% confidence interval

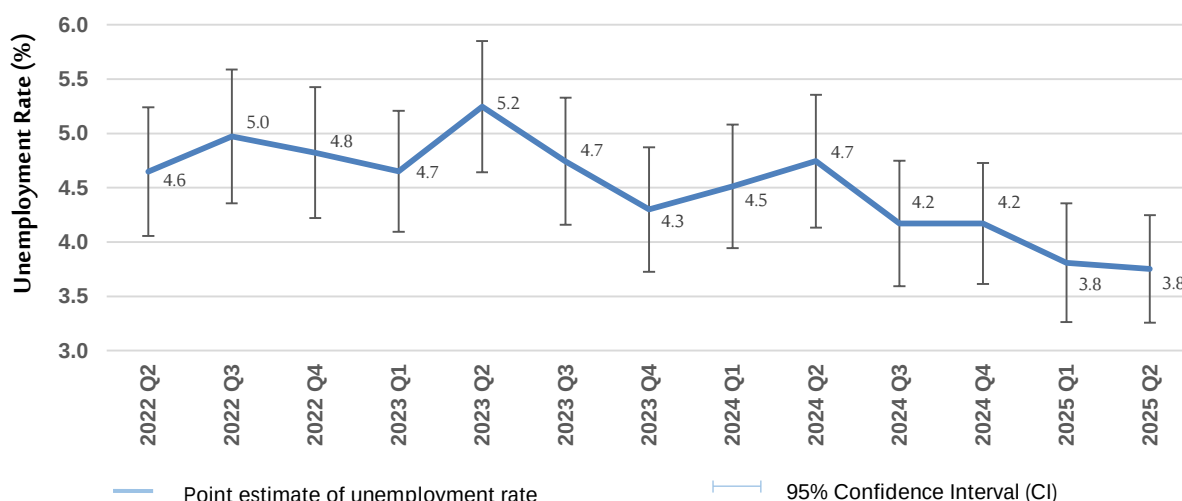
Estimated value (of the unemployment rate) $\pm$ (standard error) * (1.96)

4.5 $\pm$ (0.275) * (1.96)
(4.5 $\pm$ 0.539)

Explanatory Notes (Page 3)

This means, the 95 percent confidence interval on the quarterly unemployment rate could range from (4.0 to 5.0). This implies that there is about 95 percent chance that the "true" unemployment rate lies within this interval. This range includes all the values range from 4.0 to 5.0. When the comparison of this estimate is done between two quarters, if any of the value within the 95 percent confidence interval of one quarter overlaps with the confidence interval of the other, it means that the estimates of this two quarters are not significantly different.

Therefore, in each quarterly labour force report, a separate table is given including approximate standard errors for some selected variables, so that users could understand this statistical scenario clearly.

Distribution of unemployment rates and 95% confidence intervals (2022Q2- 2025Q2)

As seen in figure, it is very important to note that, there were no statistically significant differences between the unemployment rates reported in different time periods of 2022/2025, when sampling error was considered.

Change in survey schedule

Current survey concepts and methods are very similar to those introduced at the beginning of the survey in 1990. However, some changes have been made over the years to improve the accuracy and usefulness of the data. In January 2006, some improvements were made to the labour force survey schedule in order to fulfill the requirements of data users and also to provide additional information for planning purposes. The revision was made focusing on literacy, household economic activities, and informal sector employment and under employment etc.

From January , 2013 onwards, the lower bound of working age populations is considered as age 15, hence age 15 and over population is considered as working age population. The survey schedule is updated to obtain more precise information on following age, informal employment, informal sector, secondary occupation, wages & income , unemployment & trainings.

New Industry & Occupation classifications

From January 2013 onward the survey uses new industry & occupation classifications, such as
 SLIC Rev 4:- Sri Lanka Standard Industry Classification based on International Standard Industry classification - Rev.4 (ISIC Rev 4)
 SLSCO 08:- Sri Lanka Standard Classification of Occupation-2008 based on International Standard Classification of Occupation-2008 (ISCO 2008)

Explanatory Notes (Page 4)**Note :**

It is important to note that, all the data published here are the estimates based on a sample survey and these are subject to sampling errors. These sampling errors can be statistically evaluated from the survey results. Therefore, sampling error is normally measured in terms of the standard error of the particular variable. Standard error could be used to calculate the confidence limits with a prescribed accuracy where the true value of the estimates lies.

Further reliability of the estimates can be expressed in terms of Coefficient of Variation (CV). The CV is a relative measure of the sampling error and is calculated as sampling error divided by the expected value of the given characteristic.

In view of this, following table is given to show the estimates for some selected variables, its standard error, CV and 95% Confidence interval.

It is also important to note that all the estimates we publish in this report are subject to sampling error and one should be cautious in the interpretation of results, especially with respect to the trends over time.

Estimate of Confidence Intervals for some selected characteristics

Year	Labour Force					Employed				
	No.	Standard error	C.V (%)	95% C.I.		No.	Standard error	C.V (%)	95% C.I.	
				Lower	Upper				Lower	Upper
2017	8,566,686	49,822	0.58	8,468,989	8,664,382	8,208,179	48,420	0.59	8,113,231	8,303,126
2018	8,387,759	57,008	0.68	8,275,971	8,499,546	8,015,166	55,036	0.69	7,907,245	8,123,087
2019	8,592,010	54,293	0.63	8,485,546	8,698,475	8,180,693	52,108	0.64	8,078,513	8,282,872
2020	8,466,606	58,917	0.70	8,351,075	8,582,137	7,999,093	56,610	0.71	7,888,086	8,110,101
2021	8,553,290	58,311	0.68	8,438,947	8,667,633	8,113,507	56,072	0.69	8,003,555	8,223,460
2022	8,547,062	58,034	0.68	8,433,262	8,660,862	8,147,731	56,377	0.69	8,037,181	8,258,281
2023	8,408,331	60,811	0.72	8,289,086	8,527,576	8,009,916	58,584	0.73	7,895,039	8,124,794
2024	8,315,702	59,437	0.71	8,199,151	8,432,253	7,949,751	57,380	0.72	7,837,234	8,062,267
2023Q2	8,458,175	110,268	1.30	8,241,605	8,674,746	8,014,492	106,267	1.33	7,805,781	8,223,203
2024Q2	8,386,482	112,841	1.35	8,164,859	8,608,105	7,988,626	109,302	1.37	7,773,953	8,203,300
2025Q1	8,461,936	100,567	1.19	8,264,407	8,659,464	8,139,605	97,268	1.19	7,948,557	8,330,653
2025Q2	8,491,296	102,560	1.21	8,289,854	8,692,738	8,172,638	99,002	1.21	7,978,185	8,367,092

Year	Unemployed					Unemployment Rate				
	No.	Standard error	C.V (%)	95% C.I.		Rate	Standard error	C.V (%)	95% C.I.	
				Lower	Upper				Lower	Upper
2017	358,507	11,347	3.17	336,256	380,758	4.2	0.1	3.08	3.9	4.4
2018	372,593	11,350	3.05	350,337	394,849	4.4	0.1	2.94	4.2	4.7
2019	411,318	12,814	3.12	386,191	436,444	4.8	0.1	3.00	4.5	5.1
2020	467,513	14,029	3.00	440,004	495,022	5.5	0.2	2.88	5.2	5.8
2021	439,783	13,930	3.17	412,468	467,097	5.1	0.2	3.05	4.8	5.4
2022	399,332	13,022	3.26	373,797	424,867	4.7	0.1	3.17	4.4	5.0
2023	398,415	13,036	3.27	372,852	423,978	4.7	0.1	3.15	4.4	5.0
2024	365,951	12,835	3.51	340,782	391,120	4.4	0.1	3.39	4.1	4.7
2023Q2	443,683	26,916	6.07	390,819	496,548	5.2	0.3	5.85	4.6	5.8
2024Q2	397,855	26,961	6.78	344,903	450,808	4.7	0.3	6.57	4.1	5.4
2025Q1	322,331	24,223	7.51	274,753	369,908	3.8	0.3	7.30	3.3	4.4
2025Q2	318,657	22,132	6.95	275,187	362,128	3.8	0.3	6.73	3.3	4.2

Alternative estimates

Alternative Estimates of Employment, Unemployment and Labour Force Characteristics

Official employment, unemployment and labour force characteristics are estimated at the Sri Lanka Labour Force Survey, based on the internationally comparable concepts and definitions recommended by the ILO. However the validity of the concepts and definitions used at the survey is questioned very often in some forums, for the appropriateness of these concepts and definitions in the Sri Lankan context.

The concepts and definitions, which were found to be controversial, are as below.

- (1) **Number of Hours of Work** : A person who work **at least one hour** during the reference week, is considered **employed**, under these definitions.
- (2) **Working Age Population** : All persons of **age 10 years and over** are considered to be in the working age, before 2013. However, this was changed as **age 15 and over** from 2013 onward.
- (3) **Employment Status** : All,
 - a) Paid employees, (those who work for wages/salaries).
 - b) Employers (who have at least one paid employee under them).
 - c) Own account workers (who carry out the economic activity without having anypaid employees).
 - d) Contributing family workers (who make their contribution to the economic activities carried out by their own household, without wages/salaries).

The validity of the above concepts and definitions is raised due to the following reasons.

- (1) **Number of Hours of Work** : Some pointed out that one hour per week is too low, to consider a person to be employed.
- (2) **Working Age Population** : Some pointed out those persons in the age group 10-14 yrs. are too young to be considered in the working age. (From 2013 onward the working age population is considered as age 15 and over).
- (3) **Employment Status** : Some pointed out that 'contributing family workers' may work in the family enterprise without payment because they have no other work, and so it is not appropriate to consider them as employed.

An attempt has been made to produce '**Alternative estimates of Employment, Unemployment and Labour Force Characteristics**,' by revising the original concepts and definitions so that the above issues are addressed as explained below.

The revisions made are,

- (1) **Number of Hours of Work** : Persons who work **20 hours or more per week only** are considered to be employed.
- (2) **Contributing Family Worker** : Contributing family workers are **not** considered as employed. They are considered as **economically inactive** (not in the labour force) so only, **a) paid employees b) employers and c) own account workers are considered to be employed.**

Following tables are based on the above alternative concepts and definitions.

Alternative estimates of employment, unemployment and labour force characteristics

Table 1 - Labour force status of household population 15 years & over (Alternative estimates)

Year	Household population (15 years & over)	Total labour force	Labour force partici: rate (%)	Labour Force				Not in labour Force Number
				Employed		Unemployed		
				Number	Rate (%) to total labour force)	Number	Rate (%) to total labour force)	
2014	15,134,484	7,017,985	46.4	6,669,590	95.0	348,395	5.0	8,116,499
2015	15,281,945	7,156,393	46.8	6,772,896	94.6	383,496	5.4	8,125,553
2016	15,448,679	7,325,972	47.4	6,962,973	95.0	362,999	5.0	8,122,707
2017	15,843,735	7,474,883	47.2	7,116,376	95.2	358,507	4.8	8,368,851
2018	16,196,232	7,428,999	45.9	7,056,406	95.0	372,593	5.0	8,767,233
2019	16,424,016	7,609,700	46.3	7,198,383	94.6	411,318	5.4	8,814,316
2020	16,739,396	7,438,037	44.4	6,970,524	93.7	467,513	6.3	9,301,359
2021	17,133,659	7,471,067	43.6	7,031,284	94.1	439,783	5.9	9,662,592
2022	17,161,973	7,497,884	43.7	7,098,552	94.7	399,332	5.3	9,664,089
2023	17,306,492	7,380,485	42.6	6,982,070	94.6	398,415	5.4	9,926,008
2024	17,547,864	7,445,218	42.4	7,079,267	95.1	365,951	4.9	10,102,646
2023Q2	17,411,969	7,344,514	42.2	6,900,831	94.0	443,683	6.0	10,067,455
2024Q2	17,548,937	7,492,062	42.7	7,094,207	94.7	397,855	5.3	10,056,874
2025Q1	17,032,793	7,686,993	45.1	7,364,663	95.8	322,331	4.2	9,345,800
2025Q2	17,214,317	7,525,375	43.7	7,206,718	95.8	318,657	4.2	9,688,942

Table 2- Historical table of number and rate of unemployment by age (Alternative estimates)

Year	Total		Age group									
			15 - 19		20 - 24		25 - 29		30 - 39		40 & above	
	No.	Rate	No.	Rate	No.	Rate	No.	Rate	No.	Rate	No.	Rate
2014	348,395	5.0	49,540	25.7	138,565	22.2	67,235	9.3	53,648	3.0	39,407	1.1
2015	383,496	5.4	55,557	28.6	143,351	22.0	78,592	10.4	60,768	3.4	45,229	1.2
2016	362,999	5.0	58,622	32.8	144,156	22.2	76,624	10.0	47,956	2.7	35,640	0.9
2017	358,507	4.8	46,016	25.1	135,121	19.7	79,727	10.4	53,053	3.0	44,590	1.1
2018	372,593	5.0	52,624	30.4	144,824	22.1	84,000	11.3	55,853	3.3	35,291	0.8
2019	411,318	5.4	53,652	29.3	148,046	22.4	93,793	11.8	59,009	3.4	56,818	1.3
2020	467,513	6.3	62,910	38.0	183,722	27.5	100,359	13.0	64,493	3.9	56,029	1.3
2021	439,783	5.9	39,102	30.8	187,104	29.7	97,631	12.5	66,973	4.2	48,972	1.1
2022	399,332	5.3	38,456	32.0	148,378	23.8	97,317	12.6	56,437	3.5	58,743	1.3
2023	398,415	5.4	39,737	33.5	141,290	24.0	100,763	14.2	56,381	3.7	60,244	1.4
2024	365,951	4.9	38,809	32.7	130,640	22.4	99,305	13.5	57,229	3.8	39,968	0.9
2023Q2	443,683	6.0	62,175	49.1	146,900	25.0	90,561	12.7	67,179	4.3	76,868	1.8
2024Q2	397,855	5.3	53,708	38.7	152,577	25.4	87,497	12.1	58,160	3.9	45,913	1.0
2025Q1	322,331	4.2	36,398	31.5	119,386	19.5	80,069	10.7	50,677	3.0	35,800	0.8
2025Q2	318,657	4.2	36,256	31.6	125,396	21.5	75,786	10.1	45,924	2.9	35,294	0.8

These figures are to be treated with caution as the corresponding CV (Coefficient of variation) values are high.

Table 3 - Currently Employed persons by Industry group (No. and percentage) (Based on ISIC Fourth Revision) - (Alternative estimates)

Year		Total	Industry group																
			1	2	3	6	7	8	9	10	11	13	14	15	16	17	19	20	Other
2021	No.	7,031,284	1,645,518	47,771	1,236,731	643,441	1,015,162	452,687	183,091	71,279	177,033	76,063	129,244	476,399	373,300	168,807	109,266	181,500	43,994
	%	100.0	23.4	0.7	17.6	9.2	14.4	6.4	2.6	1.0	2.5	1.1	1.8	6.8	5.3	2.4	1.6	2.6	0.6
2022	No.	7,098,552	1,624,304	54,869	1,273,780	626,142	1,021,153	450,290	195,864	69,084	179,777	81,766	135,361	449,381	429,513	164,503	142,340	135,921	64,505
	%	100.0	22.9	0.8	17.9	8.8	14.4	6.3	2.8	1.0	2.5	1.2	1.9	6.3	6.1	2.3	2.0	1.9	0.9
2023	No.	6,982,070	1,565,483	60,338	1,242,417	539,663	994,013	476,430	239,278	77,115	174,986	84,258	126,467	435,718	403,080	181,525	182,460	141,912	56,928
	%	100.0	22.4	0.9	17.8	7.7	14.2	6.8	3.4	1.1	2.5	1.2	1.8	6.2	5.8	2.6	2.6	2.0	0.8
2024	No.	7,079,267	1,617,302	58,145	1,249,437	561,979	1,050,283	499,891	230,156	78,001	156,020	81,737	144,857	415,785	396,749	179,543	182,482	121,181	55,717
	%	100.0	22.8	0.8	17.6	7.9	14.8	7.1	3.3	1.1	2.2	1.2	2.0	5.9	5.6	2.5	2.6	1.7	0.8
2023Q2	No.	6,900,831	1,545,137	70,736	1,261,278	511,778	1,002,492	464,253	227,391	80,709	164,820	93,232	107,570	433,470	408,281	162,791	173,028	149,101	44,764
	%	100.0	22.4	1.0	18.3	7.4	14.5	6.7	3.3	1.2	2.4	1.4	1.6	6.3	5.9	2.4	2.5	2.2	0.6
2024Q2	No.	7,094,207	1,597,732	57,663	1,312,374	554,058	1,055,696	465,239	227,693	83,440	151,965	89,414	156,838	420,438	379,164	169,905	181,194	131,170	60,226
	%	100.0	22.5	0.8	18.5	7.8	14.9	6.6	3.2	1.2	2.1	1.3	2.2	5.9	5.3	2.4	2.6	1.8	0.8
2025Q1	No.	7,364,663	1,504,148	54,357	1,345,479	593,113	1,060,341	477,728	246,060	98,875	222,851	96,798	171,634	446,414	440,477	198,096	187,176	162,471	58,646
	%	100.0	20.4	0.7	18.3	8.1	14.4	6.5	3.3	1.3	3.0	1.3	2.3	6.1	6.0	2.7	2.5	2.2	0.8
2025Q2	No.	7,206,718	1,637,649	38,061	1,248,117	594,242	1,029,593	458,164	243,880	75,912	183,429	94,950	136,186	458,821	416,372	164,318	188,733	178,402	59,886
	%	100.0	22.7	0.5	17.3	8.2	14.3	6.4	3.4	1.1	2.5	1.3	1.9	6.4	5.8	2.3	2.6	2.5	0.8

Note: The tabulation groups based on ISIC (Rev.4) are indicated as A,B,C.....U. Due to the limitations on reliability (based on CV), some of these groups have been combined.

Industry Group

1 Agriculture, forestry and fishing (A)

2 Mining & quarrying (B)

3 Manufacturing (C)

6 Construction, Electricity, gas, steam and air conditioning supply, Water supply, sewerage, waste management and remediation activities (D, E,F)

7 Wholesale and retail trade, repair of motor vehicles and motor cycles(G)

8 Transportation and storage (H)

9 Accommodation and food services activities (I)

10 Information and communication (J)

11 Financial and insurance activities (K)

13 Professional, scientific and technical activities (M)

14 Administrative and support service activities (N)

15 Public administration and defence compulsory social security (O)

16 Education (P)

17 Human health and social work activities (Q)

19 Other service activities (S)

20 Activities of households as employers; undifferentiated goods and services - producing activities of households for own use (T)

Other

Other

12 Real estate activities (L)

18 Arts, entertainment and recreation (R)

21 Activities of extra territorial organizations & bodies (U)

2025

Sri Lanka Labour Force Survey Quarterly Report 2nd Quarter

The Vision of DCS

"To be the leader in the region in producing timely statistical information to achieve the country's development goals."

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